INCH-POUND

A-A-54589A
16 April 1993

SUPERSEDING
A-A-54589
10 February 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TAPES, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOR

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description

This Commercial Item Description describes sterilization indicator tapes suitable for use in steam sterilization procedures.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization indicator tape shall be a creped paper-back design, suitable for use in sealing or holding surgical pack wrappers, or for application to stainless steel, enamel, porcelain, or glass, to indicate that these items have been subjected to prolonged exposure to high temperature encountered in steam sterilization in hospital sterilizers. The tape shall be suitable for use in sealing or securing a variety of materials used to package items for steam sterilization to include reusable nonwoven, paper, plastic and paper/plastic combination wrapping materials. The tape shall be supplied in the following sizes and styles:

Size 1 - 1/2 inch wide, 60 yards long.
Style A - Unit quantity - 12 rolls.

Size 2 - 3/4 inch wide, 60 yards long.
Style B - Unit quantity - 48 rolls.

AMSC N/A FSC 6510

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Size 3 - 1 inch wide, 60 yards long.
Style C - Unit quantity - 36 rolls.
Style D - A blue base color tape designed specifically for use with disposable wraps. Unit quantity - 36 rolls.

The sterilization and sealing tape shall be creped paper-back design with one side adhesive coated and paper-backed side treated with chemical indicator lines which change color when exposed to steam sterilization cycles. The tape shall require no moisture, heat or other special preparation prior to use. The tape shall be wound with the adhesive side in and on a 3 inch core to permit dispensing of required lengths by use of a standard tape dispenser.

The paper shall be of a quality to allow the tape to be unwound from the roll to hold the surgical pack securely closed during sterilization, and to be removed from the pack after sterilization without breakage and/or delamination. Pencil or permanent ink markings on the paper backing of the tape shall be legible after sterilization.

The adhesive material shall be such that the tape will adhere immediately and firmly to clean, dry surfaces to which the tape is applied during sterilization operations, without wrinkling, curling, breaking or lifting. There shall be no separation of the adhesive from the backing upon unwinding the rolls. The adhesive shall cause the tape to hold securely in place during sterilization. After sterilization, the tape shall continue to securely hold the surgical pack so that the sterility of its contents shall be maintained for necessary periods of storage. After sterilization, and when used with reusable woven and nonwoven wrappers, the adhesive material shall permit removal without breaking and leaving residue on the wraps.

The paper backing shall be impregnated with chemical indicators in the form of diagonal lines which shall uniformly and clearly change color to indicate exposure to steam sterilization cycles. Pencil or permanent ink marking on the paper backing shall remain legible after sterilization. In addition, the paper backing shall accept adhesive labels such as those normally used to designate expiration dates and sterilization load records.

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The tape shall be free of tears, cuts, holes, perforations, grease, dirt, or foreign matter.

Workmanship. The sealing tape shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Roll (RO)

For Size 1, Style A, one package containing twelve rolls, each roll containing sixty yards, 1/2 inch wide, as specified, constitutes one unit.

For Size 2, Style B, one package containing forty-eight rolls, each roll containing sixty yards, 3/4 inch wide, as specified, constitutes one unit.

For Size 3, Style C and D, one package containing thirty-six rolls, each roll containing sixty yards, 1 inch wide, as specified, constitutes one unit. For Style D, a blue base color tape designed specifically for use with disposable wraps shall apply.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one roll of sterilization sealing tape.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for test, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 4.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one roll of tape.

Tests specimens. Three specimens for each test shall be taken from each sample roll. The first three laps of tape shall be removed and specimens for testing shall then be taken from the beginning and two other areas near the end and near the midpoint of the roll. The average of the three values obtained for each test on each roll shall be used to determine compliance with requirements.

Test conditioning. The tape shall be conditioned for not less than 24 hours at 73°F ± 3.5°F and 48 percent minimum relative humidity, and shall be tested under these conditions.

Tests Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. tests shall include, cut shall not be limited to the following:

Tensile breaking strength, wet. Samples of tape, 11 inches in length, shall be immersed in boiling water 5 minutes and then immediately, transferred to a container of water at 73°F ± 3.5°F, where they shall remain until tested. Testing shall be completed within 10 minutes. The sample to be tested shall be removed from the water and placed, adhesive side up, on paper toweling for not more than 5 seconds, to absorb excess water. The breaking strength shall be no less than 4.5 pounds per inch width.

Tensile breaking strength, dry. The procedure for testing breaking strength of dry tape shall be as described in ASTM Method No. D3759. The breaking strength shall be no less than 16 pounds per inch width.

Ultimate elongation, dry. The procedure for testing ultimate elongation of dry tape shall be as described in ASTM Method No. D3759. The elongation shall be no less than 5 percent.

Thickness test. The thickness of the tape shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Method No. D3652. Maximum value shall be 0.008 inches.

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Adhesion Test (steel). The tape shall be tested to determine compliance with requirements specified in ASTM Method No. D3330. The adhesion value shall be 30 ounces per inch width, minimum.

Humidity test. A roll with 10 ± 1 yards of tape shall be suspended in a vertical position over water in a sealed container for 7 days at 73°F ± 3.5°F. At the end of this period, the tape shall be removed and immediately tested for adhesion to steel. When the tape is unwound at 6 to 8 inches per second, there shall be no adhesive transfer or splitting and the backing shall not break. Examine the outer laps of tape for each roll for color change. The adhesion to steel value shall not be less than 25 ounces per inch width.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	SIZE	Style
6530-00-299-9822	TAPE, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOR.	1	A
6530-01-347-0823	TAPE, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOR.	2	B
6530-01-242-2337	TAPE, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOR.	3	C
6530-01-330-3215	TAPE, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOP.	3	D

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2400

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54589A	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 16 April 1993

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
TAPES, SEALING, STERILIZATION INDICATOR

4 NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6 SUBMITTER

a NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b ORGANIZATION	
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7 DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403, Falls Church VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756 2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete* 98 791

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